



Josephine's Dishwasher



Josephine Garis Cochran was a female American inventor and entrepreneur who created the world's first successful hand-powered dishwasher. She was born in 1839.

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Dishwasher

Josephine set out to design a washing device, after discovering that her plates and saucers were often chipped from handwashing. She might have enjoyed entertaining with dinner parties, but she did not enjoy the washing up. She found a way to automate this household chore, hands-free.

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To solve her problem, she designed and invented a washing up machine. She designed and built her dishwasher and her first patent was issued in 1886. After this, she formed the Garis-Cochran Dish-Washing company so that she could manufacture it.

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Cochran's design used gears, pistons, pipes and a rack with a motor that applied water pressure. Cochran designed a set of wire compartments, which fitted plates, cups and saucers. Hot soapy water could be pumped in from a copper boiler to make dishes cleaner.

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Her new machine was shown in the World Columbian Exposition of 1893. Hotels and restaurants were quick to show interest in her machine. She won a prize for her new machine here.

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At the time of invention, the machine's larger size was not suited to most homes. But by the 1950s, there was more hot water in homes, and stronger dishwashing detergent.

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In 1949, the Garis-Cochran Dish-Washing company became part of KitchenAid®, and the first KitchenAid® dishwasher based on Cochran's design was manufactured. Today, dishwashers are a standard household appliance for many households around the world.

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